TA studio brief — Framing a site-specific visual brief

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 1 Part 2 · Big question: How do architects and public artists analyse spatial context, sightlines, and structural form to write a rigorous studio brief?

TA practical setup & focus

Provide clear acetate grids and architectural reference cards showing strong truss, arch, and cantilever forms.

Studio kit: Site architecture reference packs, A3 studio brief sheets, 2B/4B graphite, fineliners, toned paper strips, acetate grids, scale rulers

Key words to prompt

• site-specific: Designed deliberately to respond to the architecture, materials, and viewpoints of a particular place.

• sightline: The direct line of view from an audience position to the artwork.

• void: A deliberate open negative space carved through or framed by a solid structure.

• constraint: A practical boundary (scale, material palette, or relief depth) that focuses a design.

• elevation: A flat, proportional side-on drawing of a structure.

Supported route steps

1. Use the acetate grid to sketch the main arch or truss shape and its open triangle voids into the elevation box.

2. Attach two small texture rubbings/swatches to show your planned surface grain.

3. Complete the four structured sections of the Studio brief (Theme, Main shape, Three materials, Contrast rule).

Check: Proportional elevation drawn with two texture swatches and four brief sections completed.

Review & exit support

Exit question: Why does a strong structural design brief plan for both the 3-metre view and the 30-centimetre view?

Staff note: Staff preparation only: review how to guide pupils from architectural photo analysis to an annotated elevation and studio brief.